

Yeoford **Village Voice**

Distributed free to homes in Yeoford and District, Devon

April 2026

Issue 420



This month: Yeofest! Easter! Clock Change! Honey Dark! Spring! Wordsearch! Chocolate! Two Bank Holidays! Bunnies! And much, much more...

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YEOFORD CRICKET CLUB

Captain: Paul Coren 01363 84238

YEOFORD 200 C£UB

Contact: club200yeoford@outlook.com

USEFUL CONTACTS

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999 in an Emergency
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0800 405040 Transport Police

EMERGENCIES

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0800 807060 Environment Hotline
0800 111999 Gas Emergency
0800 1691144 Water Leaks/Burst Mains
0845 1551004 Roads/Street Lights
0310 1234999 RSPCA
0845 6000388 Social Services

MEDICAL

01363 772227 Redlands Primary Carey
01647 24272 Cheriton Bishop Surgery
111 NHS Choices (non-Emergency)
01363 775588 Crediton Hospital
01363 772062 Boots Pharmacy
01363 773030 Crediton Pharmacy
01363 772841 Lloyds Pharmacy
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01363 773401 QE Academy Trust

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0845 7484950 National Rail Enquiries
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01884 255255 Mid Devon District Council
0207 2197037 Mel Stride MP
mel.stride.mp@parliament.uk

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Editorial

April Fools, April Showers, April Skies...

It's all about April. Actually the more I write it, the weirder the word looks. Funny how the brain works. Apparently you can spell it multiple ways. Anyway, by the time you read this, the clock's will have sprung forward, which personally I find really does make a positive difference, the lighter evenings actually giving you a chance of getting out for some fresh air after work. Easter is on its way, which means a nice long weekend, school holidays, longer days and spring properly kicking in...which means it'll probably snow, ah well. Gah, now I've spoiled the imagery, unless you like snow of course.

So, what's been going on? Well, as ever, Yeofest was a roaring success up at the hall, the weather held up, the punters came. and they drank and were very merry, more of that inside.

What else? The trains should hopefully be back after another week or so of, the albeit pretty reliable but non-connecting, rail replacement buses.

There's not a lot happening this month to be honest and the pub is off on their holidays after Easter for a couple weeks, so checkout their opening times just in case you're aiming on ambling down there.

In other, rather dull, news, I'm still battling converting this amazing publication from the soon to be obsolete Publisher to something else. Will it be Powerpoint? Will it be Word? Maybe I'll make into a macro-laden Excel spreadsheet or just write it up by hand. The options are endless. I told you it was dull.

Have a great April/Appril/Aprill/Apryl/Aprile/Ape-ril...

Cheers...

The Editor

The Village Voice Is YOUR Village Magazine

We want to hear from you and want you to use it to convey anything you feel of interest to your fellow villagers.

Please leave any items for the YVV at Torricon, Station Road before the **20th of each month**, anything after that date may not be considered until the following month. **You must provide a name and address**, even if this is not for publication.

You can also email the editor, Jonathan, at **yvveditor@yahoo.co.uk** or phone **01363 84501**

Publishing date: **the first week of each month.**

The Village Voice accepts no responsibility for any of the information or contributions contained herein.



Local Information

YEOFORD COMMUNITY HALL

COMMUNITY HALL CHARGES (hourly rate)

	Trustee User Groups	Local Community Groups	Private Bookings (Local)	Private Bookings (Non Local)
Main Hall (includes kitchen)	£3.00	£5.00	£8.00	£10.00
Meeting Room (includes kitchen)	£2.00	£3.00	£3.50	£5.50
Party/Wedding 24hr hire	—	—	£150	£250
Party/Wedding 48hr hire	—	—	£400	£500

Exclusive field use, BBQ, Stage, Disco Equipment also available.

For bookings, please e-mail yeoford.hall@gmail.com
Or phone: 01363 84501

The latest hall calendar can be found at
www.yeoford.org/community-hall

Cover Photo

Fancy getting your picture on the front of the VV? Then send your photos, drawings, musings, or whatever to yvveditor@yahoo.co.uk and there's a good shout it'll appear on the cover!

* Yeoford Community Garden *
* Yeoford Community Hall now has an area *
* dedicated to providing a small community *
* garden. Any villagers are welcome to get *
* involved in running and maintaining the *
* garden. *
* Please speak to **Dee Hawkins** or email *
* yeoford.hall@gmail.com for further *
* information. *

Top Tip!

If you have a breakdown in an electric car you can still use the AA. Unless it's a small electric car, when you have to use the AAA...

PUNCHBOWL RECYCLING CENTRE

OPEN 7 DAYS A WEEK

MON-FRI: 09:00 - 17:00
SAT & SUN: 10:00 - 18:00

TRAINTIMES FROM YEOFORD

NB: Yeoford is a Request Stop

TO BARNSTAPLE

Mon -Fri	Sat	Sun
	0540	
0630	0633	
0725	0730	
0834	0837	
0937	0937	0938
1037	1037	1039
1137	1137	1138
1237	1238	1238
1337	1337	1335
1437	1438	1435
1537	1537	1536
1637	1637	1637
1738	1739	1736
1841	1844	1836
1943	1947	1938
2041	2043	2037
2147	2145	
2313		
Fo		

TO EXETER

Mon -Fri	Sat	Sun
0708	0713	
0813	0816	
0918	0921	
1019	1018	1017
1117	1117	1117
1216	1216	1221
1319	1319	1317
1417	1417	1417
1516	1516	1519
1617	1617	1614
1719	1720	1718
1822	1825	1818
1924	1930	1917
2023	2026	2017
2124	2123	2119
2227	2224	2226
2320	2320	
Fx		
2352		
Fo		

Fx – Monday-Thursday
Fo – Friday only
For more details, go to
GWR.com/timetables



Bus Timetables

677 (Fridays only)

Dartline Coaches

Zeal Monachorum Church	0912
Coleford Gospel Hall	0927
Colebrooke Church	0932
THE DUCK AT YEOFORD	0936
YEO VIEW	0938
Raddon Down Cross	0945
Crediton TIC High Street	0955
Exeter Sidwell Street	1020

Exeter Sidwell Street	1320
Crediton TIC High Street	1345
Raddon Down Cross	1350
THE DUCK AT YEOFORD	1355
YEO VIEW	1357
Colebrooke Church	1403
Coleford Gospel Hall	1408
Zeal Monachorum Church	1423

669 (Tuesdays only)

MD Buses

South Zeal Oxenham Arms	0915
Whiddon Down Shelter	0922
Hittisleigh Cross	0930
Crockernwell	0945
Cheriton Bishop School	0947
THE DUCK AT YEOFORD	1002
Colebrooke Church	1010
Coleford Gospel Hall	1013
Crediton St Saviour's Way	1022
Crediton Morrisons	1027

Crediton Morrisons	1115
Crediton St Saviour's Way	1235
Coleford Gospel Hall	1244
Colebrooke Church	1247
THE DUCK AT YEOFORD	1255
Cheriton Bishop School	1310
Crockernwell	1313
Hittisleigh Cross	1326
Whiddon Down Shelter	1328
South Zeal Oxenham Arms	1335

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Friday 3:15-4:15pm in the Community Hall

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Contact: CHUDLEIGH POST OFFICE; TEL: 01626 852149



FROM THE PARISH COUNCIL

REPORTING A PROBLEM WITH ROADS TO DEVON COUNTY COUNCIL

All drivers will be aware that state of repair of roads in Crediton Hamlets Parish is appalling, with more and more potholes (or are they craters?) appearing. The lack of action by Devon County Council is exceedingly frustrating but please report potholes in the hope this makes a difference.

Problems with roads can be reported on the Devon County Council website:
www.devon.gov.uk/roads-and-transport/report-a-problem/

There is a link to this page under "Useful Information" on the Parish Council website
www.creditonhamlets.org.uk.

If the pothole has already been reported please add yourself to the existing report so that Devon County Council is aware that another person has reported the problem.



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The coffee morning will be on Tuesday 21st April,

10.30am in the

Hayloft at Mole Avon. The open meeting is on

Wednesday April 15th in the Boniface Centre, 10am, for a talk by **Martin Pailthorpe** on

Smallpox, Silverware and 600 years of history. It costs

£2, including refreshments, and everyone is welcome - you don't have to be a member.

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Crediton Arts Centre News

2nd April Music & Food: Jazz on the Green

4th April Theatre: The Accountment of Luke

18th April Music: True Foxes

24th / 25th April Theatre: The Uncertainty Principle

30th April Film: Last Thursday Picture Show

1st May Music: Suntou Susso

Check the website for more details

www.creditonartscentre.org

Library at the Church

Following the demise of the Mobile Library, alongside the books at the station, there is also now a small library in Yeoford Church and all are welcome to borrow books.



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Parish Voluntary Wildlife Warden

At last beautiful sunshine and I'm walking down to the ford at Binneford from Shortacombe Lane. It's bright even in the leafless woods, as the lane plunges steeply down the hill leaves the air and warmth comes up to meet me as the ford comes in view.

I trim the brambles and ivy over the little footbridge to keep it open and notice many new primrose seedlings are peeking out. I leave enough brambles hanging over to save them from being trampled.

The Binne is running very clear. The rains have washed the bottom clean. The banks look intact despite the floods and wildflowers and ferns are beginning to stick their heads up. There are wood anemones and dog mercury. Harts tongue and dry ferns. All have withstood long periods of immersion and their roots have helped hold the bank in place.

The Yeo like the Binne is now gurgling sweetly, only the lumps of wood on the bridge tell of its fury a few short weeks ago. The sheep lie in the sunshine and primroses fill the steep banks. In this moment all felt good, I'm lost in time, cut off from the crazy world in this secluded valley.

The Binne brook meets and is taken by the Yeo gurgling on through pastures and pristine ancient woods winding its way to Yeoford. Yeo-meaning river. Binne-meaning bear.

This little brook at its ford is deadly and should never be crossed when in flood. The Wildlife logbooks are now at Holy Trinity Church and the Duck at Yeoford awaiting your entries.

Anna (artonmove@hotmail.com)



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YEOFEST 16—SATURDAY 14TH MARCH 2026

Have you ever wondered how the beers get selected for Yeofest? Well, it's a complex process of travelling about, visiting beer festivals when we can, sampling ales and then perusing lists of award-winning beers. Once we have a rough selection, we try to get a balance of bitters, best bitters, red beers, stouts and golden ales, as well as plenty of mid strength session beers (around 4% ABV), milds and the odd strong one. Donations from our favourite local breweries are always a fantastic boost.

This year, the odd (very!) strong one was Scilly Stout (7%), a late replacement for the award-winning Penzance Mild which sadly we were unable to secure due to brewing issues. So, our balance was a little skewed, with three dark beers, two of which were above 6%.

Nevertheless, the drinkers were happy, and the three dark beers sold quickly, with Twickenham Brewery's amazing Honey Dark being the first ale to go. Not far behind was Gurt Coconuts Rum Stout (6.8%) and the festival Champion Rude Giant's Best. The accolade being decided the night before by the core organisation and volunteering team via a blind-tasting session, where all the beers were all sampled and in random order without knowing what they were and then the scores tallied up, before the big reveal.



YEOFEST 2026

Festival Champion Beer

- 1. RUDE GIANT – BEST**
- 2. Black Country Ales – BFG**
- 3. Twickenham Brewery – Honey Dark**



If you think organising a beer festival sounds like a breeze, we also supply souvenir glasses (this year sponsored by the wonderful Sprig and a Wish – check out their website: asprigandawish.co.uk) with a topical March hare-based design, T-shirts for our brilliant volunteers, food, this year sponsored by Sweetpeas and Paul Brimacombe, and we organise music: thank you to Busker Bernie, Rob and Jason for keeping us entertained in the daytime. And not to mention securing sponsors, those wonderful businesses and individuals without whom, Yeofest couldn't run. More about them over the page...

Everything worked well: the trains ran and the sun shone meaning people could spill out onto the recreation ground. We had around 300 drinkers through the doors, the usual CAMRA crew early on, the masses in the afternoon and the hardcore volunteers and villagers in the evening. By then we had our dancing shoes on. for the awesome Yeo Division who carried us through til the end.

Our ale enthusiasts left satisfied once again with several compliments on our selection of ales. "Best ever" one happy drinker proclaimed on his way out!



All proceeds from Yeofest go towards maintaining and running our excellent hall and recreation ground facilities and this year we are hopeful that we have made over £3,000, helping to keep hire charges affordable for all users.

This year, we once again had many amazing sponsors, and they were: The Beer Engine, Brooks Contracting Ltd., Christine Francis, Crankhouse Coffee, Crediton Milling Company, Devon Tree Services, Firebrand Brewing, GP Plumbing, Heating and Renewables, Grape & Grain, Hanlons, Hilton Barnfield, Isca Pianos, Just Gels, McCormack Training, The New Inn, Paul Brimacombe, Pete and Rod Davis, Pool n Spa, Rick & Al, Simpkins Edwards, Sprig and a Wish, Sweetpeas, SW Galvanizing, The Duck at Yeoford, Tom Cobley Tavern, Ubicom, Utopian and Wild Earth Tattoo Studio.



Without these companies and individuals, the festival would be a lot harder to make a success and speaking of individuals who make it a success, a huge thank you to the volunteers and organisers who gave a ridiculous amount of time and effort on the run-up, on the day and clearing up the day after.

We are always seeking new helpers, sponsors and organisers. If you would like to get involved next year, please give us a shout. Cheers!

Yeofest Organising Committee



YEOFORD VILLAGE VOICE FUN QUIZ

So, April Fool's Day and that, let's have a April Fool's Day Quiz...

1. As a prank, what flavour of toothpaste did Burger King claim they launched?
2. Which chain tricked people into believing they were selling frozen flowers?
3. In a 1980s April Fools' Day prank, the BBC World Service announced that the Big Ben clock tower was going to be changed to what?
4. Who provided the voiceover of the famous BBC Panorama "spaghetti tree" hoax?
5. As an April Fools' prank, what type of plane did Virgin Atlantic announce they would be introducing?
6. In 2008 the BBC released footage of which flightless bird that had been captured on video demonstrating it could, in fact, fly?
7. As an April Fools' Day prank, which soda announced it was releasing a new pop that included a small shot of helium that would create a "squeaky high-pitched effect on the drinker's voice"?
8. Which famous figure once announced that at 9.47am on 1 April, the planetary conjunction between Pluto and Jupiter would mean gravity on Earth would be slightly weaker, and if you jumped in the air you would briefly float, without needing balloons?
9. In 2004 Google advertised jobs in its new Google Copernicus Hosting Environment and Experiment in Search Engineering research facility. Where was it to be based?
10. Volkswagen endeared itself to news editors by saying it was changing its name to align with a push for electric cars, then saying when questioned that it wasn't an April fool, and then revealing after everybody had reported the story, it was in fact an April fool. What was the new name?

Answers below...

WORDSEARCH SOLUTION [page 19]

COOPERLAND NEWTON STREET RES

Quiz Answers:

1. Whopper (2017); 2. Iceland (2017); 3. A digital clock named Digital Dave (1980); 4. Richard Dimbleby (1957); 5. A glass-bottomed plane (2013); 6. Penguins (2008); 7. Coca-Cola (2017); 8. Patrick Moore (1976); 9. On the moon (2004); 10. Volkswagen (2021)

YEOFORD COMMUNITY HALL—SEEKING COMMUNITY GROUPS!

Yeoford Community Hall has availability for community groups for one-offs or regular bookings on Wednesday evenings, Thursday evenings or Sunday evenings. Exercise classes, craft groups, workshops, educational events or social clubs would be warmly welcomed. Trial periods will be accommodated.

Daytime slots on occasional Tuesdays and Thursdays are also available.

West Down Chapel Yeoford Road

April 5th Easter Celebration at 11am with Peter Boddington.

April 5th Easter Praise at 3pm with Peter Boddington.

April 8th Wednesday Friends and Neighbour 2pm, Tea/Coffee and biscuits.

April 12th Sunday morning Worship at 11am with John Allan.

April 15th Ladies Bible Study at Venbridge House at 10.30am. With Tea/Coffee and Cake.

April 19th Sunday Morning Worship at 11am with London City Mission.

April 19th Sunday Lunch book with Kate on 07772 239419. This will be followed prayer fellowship 2-3pm.

April 26th Sunday Morning Worship at 11am with Glyn Oliver.

April 29th Ladies Bible Study at Venbridge House at 10.30am. With tea/Coffee and Cake.

Holy Trinity Church Yeoford

The first Messy Church for nearly a year was held in Church at the end of February. A good time was had by all. We are looking forward to celebrating Mothering Sunday with crafts and service celebrating Mothers.

Café Company Mondays from 10 till 11am except when there is Lunch Club.

Community Lunch April 13th
12:15 for 12:30

Services for April

Sunday 5th April
Easter Sunday

Family Holy Communion 9:30
Easter Egg Hunt and making an Easter Garden

Sunday 26th April
Family Service 11:15am
Craft for Children
Coffee and cake from 11am



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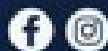
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CREDITON HAMLETS PARISH COUNCIL

The main items on the agenda of the March Council meeting comprised presentations by Airband regarding broadband upgrading proposals in the Crediton area specifically as they relate to Crediton Hamlets Parish and by Road Warden to Hittisleigh Parish regarding repair of pot-holes.

Airband are proposing upgrade of the broadband infrastructure with fixed line technology by replacement of copper wiring with fibre. The work is due to start in July 2026 with completion during January 2027. **IT IS PROPOSED THAT AIRBAND WILL GIVE AN ILLUSTRATED PRESENTATION TO THE PARISH COUNCIL MEETING ON TUESDAY 5th MAY AT YEOFORD COMMUNITY HALL TO WHICH THE PUBLIC IS INVITED TO ATTEND.** In the meantime for more information please contact community.engagement@airband.co.uk

The Council usually meets on the first Monday of the month. The next full Council meeting will be on **TUESDAY 7TH APRIL** (due to Bank Holiday) at Boniface Centre, Crediton. If you would like to read the minutes of the March Parish Council Meeting they are on the PC website. Please contact one of your councillors or Charlotte Long, the Parish Clerk (clerk@creditonhamlets-pc.gov.uk or **01363 84558**) if there is something you would like discussed at the next Council meeting. Members of the public are very welcome to attend any meeting and speak during the public session. Meeting details and contact information for Councillors are on the Parish Council website (www.creditonhamlets-pc.gov.uk)

PLEASE READ: AIR AMBULANCE

An appeal to all our villagers

If you, your children or anyone you know plays in the recreation ground please always check with them that they have returned the goals to the edge of the field.

This is because the Air Ambulance **CANNOT LAND** if the goals are in the middle of the field.

If you pass the recreation ground or see anybody playing with the goals in the centre, could you please remind them (politely) that they should be returned to the edge after use, or move them back if you find them abandoned like this.

Thank you all for your cooperation.

Yeoford Community Association

WORDSEARCH

15 places around the area (solution on p13)

C	P	Q	N	H	H	Y	G	B	S	N	Q	P	N	E
O	O	E	A	O	P	A	J	W	O	Q	C	A	E	N
P	H	R	K	N	T	P	L	T	A	O	S	F	O	O
P	S	U	V	O	O	I	Y	F	L	F	F	M	P	T
L	I	A	S	M	O	E	D	E	M	F	O	I	A	S
E	B	M	S	B	R	R	F	E	L	O	D	B	R	N
S	N	S	X	P	U	O	B	Z	R	N	O	I	D	U
T	O	S	S	T	R	P	V	E	N	C	D	N	Y	G
O	T	Q	O	D	M	Z	J	O	L	M	T	Y	N	Z
N	I	N	R	Y	I	D	R	O	F	O	E	Y	I	T
E	R	E	N	O	T	S	N	E	P	V	C	G	P	K
I	E	W	O	O	D	L	A	N	D	H	E	A	D	C
N	H	E	B	M	O	C	A	L	L	O	H	R	C	N
O	C	F	F	Y	P	Q	H	P	I	L	A	M	Y	U
N	E	W	T	O	N	S	T	C	Y	R	E	S	Z	U



Easter Opening Times:

Thursday 2nd April 11.30am - 10.00pm

Good Friday 11.30am - 10.00pm

Easter Saturday 11.30am - 10.30pm

Easter Sunday 11.30am - 5.30pm

Easter Monday CLOSED

We will be closed Monday 6th April - Saturday 18th April inclusive.

Sunday 19th April we will be opening for drinks and a light menu. We will not be serving roast meals.

James, Sarah, Zachary, Lydia and Martha

01363 85273

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